

sers: CS Analytics/Leadership+

- Detailed usage reporting: usage dashboards - users: CSM/leadership+
- Top customer report: exec level reporting - users: CS Analytics/exec/BOD

Gainsight

Drive action: CSM-specific reporting for actioning CTAs, Success Plans, burn-down dashboard.
For CSM teams to use (CSM Managers to start/end their day in Gainsight)

- Drive action: CSM portfolio/proactive planning required that day - users: CSM/CSMM
- Drive action: at-risk customer reporting to update and act on - users: CSM/CSMM
- Customer onboarding: which customers are in onboarding and next steps - users: CSM
- Customer health: overall health is calculated in Gainsight - CSM/CSMM
- Stage enablement and expansion: in Gainsight for detailing required actions and missing customers; data integrated for Tableau to provide aggregated analysis and attribution - users: CSM

Guiding principles

1. Clarity around which tools to use for which purposes
1. Mitigate duplication across reporting tools (some duplication is necessary and encouraged)
1. Actionable for end-users where applicable to drill down and complete tasks or update activity logs
1. Visually designed to ensure clarity of recommendations

SECTION: customer-success/using-salesforce-within-customer-success.md

- Using Salesforce within Customer Success (Current)
- Account Onboarding
- Customer Success Manager Summary
- Account Triage
- Account Engagement

On an account view in Salesforce, there is a Customer Success section, with the following fields:

- Health Score - A field to record the overall customer health
- CSM Sentiment - A field to list the CSM's sense of the customer's health
- GitLab Customer Success Project - Where you enter the URL of the project created using the template described above
- Customer Slack Channel - A field to record Slack channel(s) used for internal and external customer collaboration. If a channel is internal, make sure it follows the naming convention a<customer-name>-internal per Communication Chat
- Solutions Architect - The Solutions Architect aligned with the account
- Customer Success Manager - The Customer Success Manager aligned with the account

Salesforce Objects

Salesforce operates using a series of objects. Standard objects are objects that are included with Salesforce. Common business objects like Account, Contact, Lead, and Opportunity are all standard objects.

Custom objects are objects that you create to store information that's specific to your company or industry. For GitLab, we have created four custom objects that are specific to Customer Success. These are POV's and PS Engagements (PSE's). We can link these custom objects to accounts and opportunities, and create automations such as allowing us to auto-populate specific fields and notify users when a task needs to be completed.

Professional Services Engagements (PSE) objects

PSE objects in Salesforce are used to track the progress of our PSE's that are agreed upon with our customers. These PSE's describe the professional services that GitLab will deliver to our client. As this is related to a billable service that we are extending to our clients all PSE's must be related to an appropriate Opportunity and an Account. For a walkthrough, see the GitLab Unfiltered PS Engagement Object video

The Opportunity that each PSE is associated with will contain information relevant to the Opportunity (Amount, IACV etc.) while the PSE itself will house notes, details and monitor the progress of the PSE (Go Live Date, Kick Off Date etc.). If a client would like to move forward with many professional services at once then all of these services would be encapsulated and related through one Opportunity and one PSE.

If an existing client, who previously purchased professional services from GitLab, would like to purchase addition professional services, then a new Opportunity and PSE would be created in Salesforce. Review our section in the handbook about creating new opportunities if you have any questions around the Opportunity creation process.

In order to track the contacts that are associated with a PSE, we utilize the PSE-Contact Association list. This can be accessed by navigating to the PSE page layout and locating the PSE-Contact Association related list. From there you can create a new association by looking up the contact that is associated with this PSE. Multiple contacts can be associated with a single PSE.

Fields

PS Team

- Owner - the owner or overseer of the project
- Project Team - the planned team for the project

PS Info

- PS Engagement Name - the unique identifier for the project
- Engagement Type - whether the project is fixed, time based, etc.
- Opportunity - link to the related PS Opportunity
- Opportunity Amount - the booked amount (from the PS Opportunity)
- Success Criteria - the pre-defined criteria for what success will look like at the end of this engagement

- Sertifi EContract - link to the Sertifi contract
- Status - the current project status
 - Backlog - new booking, project initiation has not started
 - On Hold - project is on hold due to the customer
 - Initiation - in kick off or planning stages
 - In Progress - the project is being worked on
 - Closure - waiting for customer signature or finalizing paperwork but the services have been rendered
 - Completed - the project is 100%, all items have been signed-off, and this PS Engagement object is complete
 - Cancelled - the project has been cancelled
- SOW Link - link to the SOW
- Collaboration Project - link to the GitLab collaboration project
- % Complete - the PS engineer's estimate on the project's completion
- General Notes - free-form text for notes about the project

Project Tracking

- Scoped Hours - hours scoped during the SOW
- Hours Consumed - billable hours consumed to date
- Remaining Project Hours - Remaining hours of the project
- Hours Updated Date - the date when Hours Consumed was last updated

PSE Approval

- Approved - PS management has signed off that the project can begin
- Approver - the Salesforce user who ticked the Approved box
- Passive acceptance language in SOW? - does the SOW contain passive acceptance language to complete the SOW?
- Signed Acceptance from Customer - confirmation GitLab has signed approval from the customer to begin the project
- Passive acceptance used for sign off? - did we use passive acceptance to complete the SOW?
- Sign Off Date - the sign off date, whether accepted via email or by executing passive acceptance

Project Timeline

- Kick Off Date - the date the project planning and scheduling began
- Expected Start Date - the anticipated date when the technical portion of the project should begin
- Expected Completion Date - the anticipated date when the project should be completed
- Expected Project Length - anticipated project length, Expected Start Date - Expected Completion Date
- Actual Project Start Date - when work actually began for the customer
- Completed Date - the actual completed date
- Actual Project Length - actual project length, Actual Start Date - Completed Date

Kicking Off the PS Engagement Object

When starting the PS Engagement, the following fields must be filled out:

- Approved By
- Actual Project Start Date
- Expected Completion Date
- Opportunity (automatically populated)
- Scoped Hours
- Success Criteria
- Sertifi Contract
- PS Engagement Link
- Collaboration Project
- Signed Acceptance from Customer

Approved By

When the PSE object has been approved, the following are reviewed to ensure accuracy and proper execution of the SOW:

- PS management team has reviewed the SOW
- GitLab Legal has reviewed the contract, if applicable
- The SOW contract explicitly states if the customer does not sign off within 5 days, it is automatically assumed completed

Updating the PS Engagement Object

The PS Engagement Object should be updated on a frequent basis. When it is updated, the following fields should be updated for the benefit of various stakeholders:

- Status
- Hours Consumed
- Hours Updated Date
- % Complete
- If applicable, update General Notes and/or other areas

Completing the PS Engagement Object

When completing the PS Engagement Object, review all fields in the PS Engagement to ensure accuracy and completeness. Salesforce validation rules are set up to ensure the fields are complete before marking Status as Complete. As a general rule, ask the following questions:

- Are the dates accurate?
- Did we achieve the Success Criteria?
- Are all links (PS Engagement Link, Collaboration Project, etc.) correct?
- Are all required docs signed off by GitLab and the customer?
- Are all remaining fields completed and ready for review by Professional Services, Finance, and Leadership?

Once the above questions have been reviewed, the PS Engagement can be marked Completed which will trigger certain events in Salesforce for the various stakeholders.

Proof of Value (POV) objects

Please visit this page for POV documentation.

Salesforce - Customer Success Automations

New Zendesk Ticket Notifications

For all new Zendesk tickets that are created, the Customer Success Manager and Account Owner for the account that the ticket is associated with will receive an email notification alerting them of a new ticket. This currently is a one time notification that only occurs when the Zendesk ticket is first created in Salesforce.

Tracking Emails within Salesforce

Anyone communicating with a customer via email should ensure their emails are being tracked within Salesforce in the account's activity history. Even with the roll-out of Gainsight, we still log our emails to Salesforce because the emails within Gainsight's timeline can create more noise than value.

To log an email in Salesforce:

1. Log in to Salesforce
1. Click your name at the top right
1. Click "My Settings"
1. Click "Email" on the left sidebar
1. Click "My Email to Salesforce"
1. Save the email address it provides next to "Your Email to Salesforce address"

Any time you email a customer, bcc your "email to Salesforce address" on the email so that it is tracked within Salesforce.

These alternatives exist:

1. If you have an Outreach account which is linked to your GitLab email address and your Salesforce account, your emails will automatically sync with Salesforce
1. If you do not have outreach, then consider the Salesforce Chrome plugin to easily log customer-related emails

Building Reports in Salesforce

It's best practice to use an existing report rather than to create a new one, keeping it clean. If you're unsure, ask your Operations team. Building Salesforce reports can feel daunting, but here are a few tips. If you'd rather, you can watch a video on Report Builder.

1. Go to Reports in Salesforce
1. Click "New Report"
1. Choose a "Report Type"
 1. Tip: Typically, you'll want to choose Account (if you want to examine Salesforce Accounts) or Opportunity (if you want to report on open/closed Opportunities)
 1. Tip: "Report Type" is selecting the group of fields you want to use (e.g., Opportunity: all data related to the Opportunity)

1. Report structure:

1. Show: choose which Accounts/Opportunities to show (typically you want to select "all")
 2. Date field: choose a date to filter results. You can always choose "All Time"
 3. Add filters (white box): you can filter using any fields on the left side
 4. Preview: You can drag any fields as a new column. For instance, you can add Account Name, Account Owner, and Customer Success Manager/Solutions Architect
1. Once complete, either hit "Save" or "Run Report" to preview your report. If you run it, you can hit Save on the next page.
1. No matter what, make sure you save it in a folder that others can also access for transparency
1. Congrats! You're done.

SECTION: customer-success/comm-sales/_index.md

GitLab defines Commercial Sales as worldwide sales for the mid-market and small/medium business segments. Sales segmentation is defined by the total employee count of the global account. The Commercial Sales segment consists of two sales teams, Small Business (SMB) and Mid-Market (MM). The Commercial Sales segment is supported by a dedicated team of Solutions Architects (SA) and Customer Success Managers (CSM).

Role & Responsibilities

Solutions Architects

Solutions Architects are aligned to the Commercial Sales Account Executives by a pooled model. Requests for an SA will be pulled from the triage board by an SA based on multiple factors including availability, applicable subject matter expertise, and current workload.

- Engage a Commercial Solutions Architect
- Solutions Architect role description
- Solutions Architect overview

Customer Success Managers

Customer Success Managers are aligned to a book of business for their respective segment (Scale, Growth, or Strategic) and region (AMER or EMEA).

- Customer Success Manager role description
- Customer Success Manager overview and responsibilities

Sales Engagement Guidelines

Sales engagement for all Commercial Sales with SAs is documented in the Commercial Process page.

Customer Engagement Guidelines

Slack channels

For commercial accounts, we do not currently offer our customers Slack channels unless they meet specific criteria and it would be highly beneficial to both the customer and GitLab teams.

Prior to creating the channel and provisioning access for an existing account, the CSM for the account must approve its creation and use.

If the customer is evaluating GitLab or doing a POV for an upgrade, it may be worthwhile to create an ephemeral Slack channel, but the channel should be closed within 90 days and/or at project completion. The SA must approve the creation and use, with the expectation that it may be used only during the pre-sales process.

Seamless Customer Journey

A seamless customer journey requires a continuous flow of relevant information between the roles at GitLab with customer outcomes in focus. Below are some examples of the transfer of information between roles that may be required.

CSM Handoffs

- CSM to CSM handoff
- Pre-Sales to CSM handoff

SA to SA (new accounts)

- Update SA name on account team in Salesforce
- Ensure any account notes, tech stack discoveries, technical briefs or running call notes are linked to Salesforce and shared with the new SA
- Introduce new SA live on a client call
- If a POV is pending or active, update the POV record in Salesforce as required
- Ensure any current action items are identified via an issue on the Commercial SA Triage board

SECTION: customer-success/comm-sales/renewals.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

A key part of the customer relationship lifecycle is the renewal phase. CSMs must proactively track the renewal dates of their customers and align with their Account Executive (AE) to ensure that a customer renewal takes place.

Timeframe

At the beginning of each month a CSM should review their list of accounts in Salesforce and note the renewal dates for their accounts. If a renewal date is within six months the CSM should schedule two "Renewal Review" meetings with the appropriate AE and Solutions Architect (SA). The first "Renewal Review" meeting should be scheduled five months out from the renewal date and the second should be scheduled three months out from the renewal date.

Renewal Review Meeting

A "Renewal Review" meeting should have the following attendees:

- Account Executive
- Solutions Architect
- Customer Success Manager

For strategic accounts (with a ACV over \$100k) the following attendees should be added as well:

- Regional Sales Director
- CSM Regional Manager

The agenda of a "Renewal Review" meeting should include at least the following:

1. Review of the customer health score and any changes over the past few months - changes can be seen in the Timeline in Gainsight.
1. Review of support issues and the underlying reasons for any escalations.
1. Review of high priority feature requests.
1. Review of the customer's utilization of the product.
1. Review of any changes in customer's budget or staffing.

From this meeting a set of action items should be created to improve customer utilization and satisfaction with the product. These items can include:

1. Architecture review with Professional Services to address any underlying architectural weaknesses that could have contributed to an "Urgent" support escalation.
1. Product utilization review to explore GitLab functionally that the customer is not using but could benefit from.
1. Roadmap review to show the customer features that will be added to the product in the near term that may be valuable to them. This could include a discussion with Product Management for strategic customers.

Customer Cadence

The action items created from the "Renewal Review" meeting should be incorporated into the CSM customer cadence meetings and into any pending QBRs. The CSM should prioritize these reviews early in the renewal horizon.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/_index.md

Customer Success Segments

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<button class="btn btn-primary" type="button" style="padding: 15px 30px; font-size: 24px;">CSM EMEA</button>
<button class="btn btn-primary" type="button" style="padding: 15px 30px; font-size: 24px;">CSM APJ</button>
<button class="btn btn-primary" type="button" style="padding: 15px 30px; font-size:
```

24px;">CSE</button>

Mission Statement

Accelerate customer success by aligning passionate CSMs with customers to:

- Drive adoption aligned with business outcomes
- Enable customers in current and future GitLab use cases
- Expand ROI from GitLab

What is a Customer Success Manager (CSM) at GitLab?

CSMs are accountable for customer adoption, measurable outcomes, customer satisfaction, and creating true customer advocacy. We create successful customers by enabling, training, and nurturing them throughout their journey. The following areas incorporate the remit of a CSM:

- Customer Adoption - Ensure the customer is working towards or adopting their desired use cases to maturity. Ensure the successful onboarding of all intended users. Identify areas of adoption risk and establish mitigating plays and programs.
- Delivering Positive Business Outcomes - Ensure customers are meeting and exceeding their desired business outcomes so that customers can quantify and support their investment.
- Trusted Advisor - Establish "trusted advisor" relationships with the management and technical teams on the customer side while working seamlessly with our account team to deliver a best-in-class customer experience.
- Account Expansion - Lead adoption expansion beyond the customer's desired use cases and further customer return on investment (ROI). Partner with Sales to identify expansion opportunities and ensure we realize the expansion potential of a customer account.
- Leading Business Reviews - Review and celebrate progress towards, or achievement of, the customer's desired business outcomes. Address challenges with a plan for mitigation, align on upcoming and future customer business objectives.

High-Level Responsibilities of a CSM

<table><thead>

<tr>

<th>Responsibility</th>

<th>Context</th>

<th>How We Measure</th>

<th>DCI Roles</th>

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<td>Success Plans</td>

<td>Mutually agreed (Customer | GitLab) adoption plans that outline desired outcomes (e.g., improve cycle time), technical milestones required (e.g., migrate to GitLab, overcome constraints), timelines and DRIs.

These plans enable us to be proactive and ensure progress towards the customer's goals. As trusted advisors, we understand what drives value for our customers and help them achieve

it.</td>

<td>Every customer must have an active success plan</td>

<td>DRI: CSM

Consulted: AE, SA, Customer

Informed: Leadership</td>

</tr>

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<td>Onboarding</td>

<td>There are several onboarding steps in both the new and existing customer onboarding playbooks. The CSM's role is to ensure all of these topics and enablements have been covered and documented.</td>

<td>All customers are to be taken through the appropriate playbook (New, Existing Customer)</td>

<td>DRI: CSM

Consulted: AE, SA, Customer

Informed: Leadership</td>

</tr>

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<td>Cadence Calls</td>

<td>The cadence call is a proactive call. For this call to be proactive, the CSM's responsibility includes those listed in the linked cadence call page</td>

<td>Call frequency:
Customer is engaged weekly or biweekly, monthly at a very minimum

A CSM/CSE can expect to conduct a minimum number of calls as follows:
CSMs: 5-7 calls per weekCSEs: 15 calls per week</td>

<td>DRI: CSM

Consulted: AE, Customer

Informed: SA, Leadership</td>

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<td>Adoption & Expansion</td>

<td>Driving platform adoption (use cases and licenses) in line with a customer's desired business outcomes is at the heart of the CSM roleUnderstand what the customer is currently adopting and partner with the customer on enabling this use case/featureWhen an enablement or expansion playbook is open, the CSM actively drives the associated motion in the customer account</td>

<td>At any given time, a CSM will be actively driving expansion with half of their book (3-4 customers)</td>

<td>DRI: CSM

Consulted: AE, Customer

Informed: SA, Leadership</td>

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<td>Executive Business Reviews</td>

<td>We hold the business review at month 6, giving enough time passed to celebrate milestones achieved and enough time remaining to get adoption back on track where needed.The CSM is the DRI for scheduling, preparing for, presenting, and following up on the EBR, and partners with both the account team and the customer in the creation of the presentation.</td>

<td>1 EBR per customer per year at a minimum</td>

<td>DRI: CSM

Consulted: AE, Customer

Informed: SA, Leadership</td>

</tr>

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<td>Renewal</td>

<td>It is the job of the CSM to ask the 'soft' renewal question 3-4 months before the renewalThis conversation and the outcome of this conversation are tracked in Gainsight using the 'renewal call' meeting type (within the timeline entry)</td>

<td>Every customer regardless of segment or region</td>

DRI: CSM, AE, Renewals team Consulted: Customer Informed: Leadership
Managing Risk - A CSM actively manages risk in a customer account, quickly turning a customer to red when there is any potential risk of contraction or churn (even if this is unconfirmed) - The CSM is responsible for frequent communication to the account team about risk in their accounts and triggering/leading the escalation process where needed
Risk is actively managed for all customers DRI: CSM Consulted: AE, Leadership Informed: Renewals team

Please reference this page for an overview of the CSM Rhythm of Business (daily to yearly)

Please reference this page for an overview of the areas your CSM will engage with you in: CSM Points of Engagement

Customer Journey

Journey Stage	Activities
Pre-Sales & Alignment	Value Stream Discovery Sales to CS Handoff Identify Personas
Onboard	CSM Kickoff & Intro Establish Cadence Calls Create Success Plan

Enable	Use Case Enablement Workshops Measure Primary Use Case Adoption
Expand	Expansion Discovery
Optimize & Renew	Executive Business Review Ongoing Risk Review Renewal Discussions

FY25 Vision & Strategy -3 Pillars

- Vision & Strategy Deck (Internal - GitLab Only)
- Success At Scale
- Use Case Adoption
- Success Plan Services

Big Rock (Annual Strategy) Archive

- FY23
- FY24

Handbook Directory

CSM Team Metrics Overview (VIDEO)

Changelog

- CSM Process Changelog
- Gainsight Changelog
-

CSM Learning & Development

- CSM Objectives and Key Results (OKRs)
- Overview of available resources, training plans & career paths
- CSM Aspiring Leaders Program

CSM Activities

- CSM Onboarding
- CSM Rhythm of Business
- Using Gainsight
- CSM Quaterly Business Reviews
- CSM Responsibilities and Services
- CSM and Product Interaction
- CSM and Professional Services Interaction
- CSM and Support Interaction
- CSM and Partner Interaction
- Escalation Process
 - Infrastructure Escalation & Incident Process
- CSM-to-CSM Account Handoff
- CSM Roleplay Scenarios
- CSM Retrospectives
- CSM PTO Guidelines
- CSM READMEs (Optional)

Driving Platform Adoption

Landing Zones

- CI Landing Zone

Customer Metrics

- Sample Questions & Techniques for Getting to Good Customer Metrics

Platform Metrics

- Customer Use Case Adoption
- How To: DevSecOps Adoption Tracking in Gainsight
- Use Case Adoption Metrics
- The Customer Value Received with Service Ping
- Product Usage Data - Definitive Guide to Product Usage Data in Gainsight
- Metrics Based Product Usage Playbooks

Other Lifecycle Management Activities

- Transitioning a Customer from Pre-Sales to Post-Sales
- Account Engagement and Prioritization
 - Non-Engaged Customer Strategies
- Account Onboarding
- Success Plans
- Cadence Calls
- Managing Executive Relationships
- Executive Business Reviews (EBRs)
- Customer Renewal Tracking
- Customer Health Assessment and Risk Triage

- Risk Types, Discovery & Mitigation
- Workshops and/or Lunch-and-Learns

Digital Customer Programs

- Digital Customer Programs Handbook Page
- Available Customer Programs

CSM Managers

- CSM Manager Processes and CSM Leadership Team
- CSM Manager QBR Template (GitLab Internal)
- CSM Promotion Template (GitLab Internal)

CSM Tools

The following articulates where collaboration and customer management is owned:

1. Customer Collaboration Projects: Shared project between GitLab team members and customer. Used to prioritize/plan work with customer.
 1. Google Drive: Internal. Used to capture call notes and other customer related documents.
 1. Chorus: Internal. Used to record Zoom calls.
 1. Using Calendly with Chorus: Instructions on Calendly set up with Chorus.
 1. Gainsight: Internal. Used to track customer health score, logging customer activity (i.e. calls, emails, meetings)
 1. Issue Prioritization Dashboard: Internal. Used to track customer requested issues.

Education and Enablement

In Customer Success Management, it is important to be continuously learning more about our product and related industry topics. The education and enablement handbook page provides a dashboard of aggregated resources that we encourage you to use to get up to speed.

SFDC useful reports

Tracking opportunities for your assigned Strategic Account Executive (SAEs)

To ensure that opportunities are listed with the correct Order Type, this Salesforce report shows you all of the opportunities that have closed, or are soon to close, with your SAEs. Tracking Order Type is important since CSM team quota and compensation depend on this. Please reference the latest Sales Compensation Plan information to know what is counted.

Next steps for you:

1. Customize this SFDC report where "Account Owner = your SAEs"; "CSM = You"
1. Save report
1. Subscribe to report when "Record Count Greater Than 0" and Frequency = Weekly (You'll get a weekly email as a reminder to look at the report)

1. If you find an opp that is tagged incorrectly, chatter (@Sales-Support) in the opportunity and let them know there is a mistake (example)

Related pages

- Dogfooding in Customer Success
- Customer Success & Market Segmentation
- Responsibility Matrix and Transitions
- Customer Success' FAQ
- Using Salesforce within Customer Success
- Customer Success Vision
- GitLab Positioning
- Product Stages and the POCs for each
- How to Provide Feedback to Product
- Sales handbook
- Support handbook
- Workshops and Lunch-and-Learn slides
- Researching Customer Questions

SECTION: customer-success/csm/account-handoff.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

CSMs will need to occasionally transfer accounts they have been working with to another CSM (e.g. a CSM changes territories, a realignment occurs in Sales, a need to equalize books of business, etc.), and they should use this handbook page to help guide them through important questions and topics during the handoff.

Below are checkpoints during the account handoff process that CSMs can use to keep track of information they will need in order to successfully transition accounts. For the sake of this page, most of this guidance is directed towards the new CSM but is helpful information for everyone involved.

Account Handoff CTA

The first step once you are aware of a handoff is for the new CSM to open an CTA in Gainsight. This is where you will track completion of tasks necessary to a successful handoff. Be sure to select the "Account Handoff" playbook and assign the relevant tasks to the previous and new CSM.

Account Handoff CTA Tasks

- Old CSM: Review account handoff handbook page
- Old CSM: Ensure the success plan and any CTAs are updated, and that the Attributes tab in Gainsight contains links to the collaboration project, meeting notes doc, and triage issue (if applicable)

- New CSM: Review account handoff handbook page
- New CSM: Try to answer the handover questions listed below and discuss them together with the old CSM in the scheduled handover meeting
- Old CSM: Schedule an internal meeting between the current CSM & new CSM to review account details (collaboration project, success/command plans, meeting notes, EBRs, account history, etc.)
- Old CSM: Add new CSM to any Slack channels
- New CSM: Turn on watch notifications for the collaboration project
- Old CSM: Introduce new team on next cadence call (schedule one if there is not one upcoming)
- Old CSM: Send follow up email to the customer with the new CSM's contact information
- New CSM Manager: Assign the account (and relevant child accounts) to the new CSM in Gainsight
- Old CSM: Assign any open CTAs and the success plan (and its objectives/tasks) to the new CSM
- Old CSM: Delete the cadence call calendar events (if created internally); or, if the events were created by the customer, reach out to ask that the customer invites the new CSM to the events directly
- New CSM: Create and send out a new invite for cadence calls, to ensure there is no disruption, as some customers' internal systems do not cooperate with Google Calendar
- New CSM: Review open/pending support tickets and subscribe to all tickets, which the old CSM was watching
- Old CSM: Remove yourself from all support tickets and its CC field
- New CSM: Schedule additional sync with old CSM if needed; otherwise close this CTA

As you follow the tasks in the CTA and collaborate amongst each other, be aware of the following suggestions to ensure a seamless handoff experience.

Account Handoff: Compensation Specific Systems Process

Many of our internal processes rely on accurate assignments in our CRMs. This includes the way CSM/E variable compensation is tracked and attributed.

Key Fields & Their Use

Field Name	Source of Truth (SOT)	Location	Other Locations Updated by SOT	Description
Customer Success Manager	Gainsight C360	SFDC Account Page		Represents who is assigned to the customer
CSM Compensation Pool	Gainsight C360	SFDC Account Page		Assigns the account to a compensation pool. This is the "live" version of the pool
Compensation Pool Team	SFDC Opportunity	N/A		This field is updated by the CSM Compensation Pool team field on the SFDC Account and is stamped at opportunity closure. It then represents the Compensation Pool who will receive credit for the opportunity.
Compensation Pool Team Override	SFDC Opportunity	N/A		When the Compensation Pool Team field is stamped with the incorrect pool the process outlined below uses this field to override the stamped value.

Types of Coverage Transfers and How to Handle Them

Handoff between two named resources (CSM/A to CSM/A)

DRI: New CSM/A being assigned

1. On the day of the transfer, change the name listed as the Customer Success Manager in Gainsight to the new named resource
1. If the new CSM/A is associated with a different CSM Compensation Pool, update the CSM Compensation Pool in Gainsight to the new CSM/A's pool.

CSM/A to CSE Organization

DRI: CSM/A that the customer is transferring away from

1. On the day of transfer change the name listed as the Customer Success Manager in Gainsight to TAM Scale. This is the name that represents the CSE organization as a whole in our CRMs.
1. Any open Success Plan with this customer should be closed and an update in Gainsight should be added which indicates the handover to CSE.
1. Close all open / pending CTA's within Gainsight for the customer which is about to be handed over.
1. Take a look at the Collaboration-Project and close old issues assigned to you. If there is nobody (ie an SA) going to continue using the project, consider archiving it.
1. The CSM Compensation Pool will need to be changed. Change it to the CSE pool that represents the Geo of the customer:
 1. CSEAMER1
 1. CSEEMEA1
 1. CSEAPAC1
 1. CSEPUBSEC1

Generally speaking there is no direct assignment to a specific CSE like an account was assigned to a CSM. The CSE team will be best involved by letting the AE or SA opening a CSE help request, in which the CSE can introduce their role to the customer and how CSE team works. Going forward, CSE help requests should be used again and again by the AE / SA / RM, when a situation at the customer arises, which needs help by a CSE team member.

CSE Organization to CSM/A

DRI: CSM/A the customer is transferring to

1. On the day of the transfer, change the name listed as the Customer Success Manager in Gainsight to the new named resource
1. Update the CSM Compensation Pool in Gainsight to the new CSM/A's pool.

How to handle overrides

At GitLab, we value Collaboration. The stance we take as far as making sure Salesforce Opportunities are attributed to the right compensation pools is that we lean in on that value and work together to ensure the right pool is being compensated for the opportunities that close shortly after a transfer is made. The managers associated with the compensation pools involved are responsible for agreeing which opportunities may need an override of the compensation pool that was stamped at the time of close. In the case of a disagreement, the

Geo's senior leader should make the final decision. If an agreement results in a need for an override, the CSM/E Manager should chatter @sales-comp on the opportunity that needs the override.

Topics to Cover

Valuable Questions for the Handover

To ensure a smooth handover and provide clear guidelines for the handover meeting between the new and old CSM, we have developed a set of handover questions. Initially, these questions should be posed by the new CSM. Subsequently, the old CSM should address and answer the outstanding questions during the handover meeting. When answering these questions, it might be helpful to look at the Google Drive folder for the customer, Gainsight, Salesforce, Zendesk and the corresponding collaboration project.

Communication / Collaboration

- Company information (Vertical, Size, Internal Team structure)
- Customer contacts (Names, Roles, Team, How involved are they?)
- Who should I contact with my welcome email?
- Do they have any other calls with GitLab apart from Cadence Calls?
- How and how often are you in contact with the customer? (Collaboration Project, E-Mail)
- How do you use the collaboration project? (Issue for every cadence call? Issue for every ongoing objective/ initiative? Is it up to date? Can we close any issues?)
- How often does the customer usually communicate with you outside of calls?
- Who are the most important contacts from the customer and who do you interact with regularly?
- Who are the most important contacts within GitLab? Who should I talk to?
- Do you have any Slack Channels for the Customer?

Documentation

- Where are all meetings notes of the customer?
- Which documents are shared with the customer?

Usage

- What are their primary use cases for GitLab?
- How do they use GitLab?
- Which features do they use?
- Do you have an architecture diagram?
- Which other tools do they use (JIRA, Jenkins, GitHub, etc.)?

Other

- Do you have any training scheduled or planned with them?
- What are the ongoing initiatives? What is the current status?
- What are you currently working on with the customer/ what are your current efforts?
- Are there any open CTAs in Gainsight?
- Are there any open/ pending support tickets?

License

Discuss the state of the customer's license, such as:

- Active users count
- True-up assessment
- Upcoming renewal

Communication

One of the most important parts of a handoff is excellent transparent and timely communication. It's important for the new CSM to have a thorough understanding of the communication channels used to interact with the customer.

- What is the customer's preferred method of communicating?
- How often does the customer usually communicate with us outside of calls?
- Who are the most important contacts and who do we interact with regularly?
- What is the frequency for cadence calls?

Collaboration Project

Does a collaboration project exist? If not, discuss with the previous CSM to understand why not and evaluate if it would be helpful going forward or not. If yes, review all open issues and ask the previous CSM to update/close any that may be out of date. It may be worthwhile to skim closed issues to understand what types of initiatives or questions they've had in the past.

Pay special attention to the customer's product sentiment and their feature requests, and check if the list of feature requests is up to date, are they prioritized, how many have been shipped, etc. If there are any gaps, ask the previous CSM for any additional context they may have.

Gainsight

While all information in Gainsight is important, the below sections have been found to be the most useful to review when getting up to speed on an account.

Attributes

Review the "Attributes" tab in the Gainsight account to get a high-level overview of account-related details.

Health Score

Review their health score and any timeline entries associated with it, and discuss the history of the relationship, as well as what the previous CSM anticipates from the customer going forward.

Success Plan

Review their success plan to understand the strategic objectives the customer cares about. If

it's out of date or empty, sync with the previous CSM to get their feedback and determine a strategy to build the success plan out.

Adoption

Understand what stages the customer is using on GitLab or on other tools; if any stages are unknown, ask the customer once you've started cadence calls with them.

Opportunities

Review the open opportunities for the account; is there an upcoming renewal, or is there an upgrade potential? Additionally, by clicking into a closed-won opportunity, you can access the command plan that SAEs/AEs complete during the sales process.

Salesforce Activities

If you're interested in past email exchanges, these can be found in the "Salesforce Activities" tab on the account, which if you click on the eyeball will direct you to Salesforce to view the contents. If there are several entries with the same title, choose the most recent one, as it will also show the history of the messages in the email thread.

Meetings

Cadence Calls

Review the cadence call schedule, and the usual list of attendees. Also review agendas for recent cadence calls to familiarize on the topics that are currently being discussed.

Depending on the situation, it may be beneficial for both the new CSM and the customer to have a slower transition (1-2 months). In this case, for cadence calls, it's helpful for the old CSM to lead the cadence calls at first, while the new CSM shadows, and both CSMs pair on any questions or follow up, until the new CSM is ready to take over leading and be solo.

Meeting Notes

Meeting notes docs should be in the standard location in Google Drive; if there isn't a folder for the customer there, create one. If there isn't a notes doc in the folder, ask the previous CSM for a link to their notes and ask them to move the notes to the folder. Also do a search within Google Drive of the customer name to identify any other relevant documents or materials and move any to the folder if not already there.

Read through past meeting notes to get full clarity of the history of our engagement, and take special note of any meeting notes from past EBRs.

Meeting History

It can be helpful to look at the history of the types of calls the previous account team has had with the customer. This information most likely can already be found in the meeting notes and/or Gainsight timeline, but if you want to get a list for a high-level understanding of the face-to-face meetings the customer has been involved in, you can pull up the calendars of the

SAE/AE, SA, and CSM and search for the customer name in Google Calendar to get a list of all meetings they've had with them in chronological order.

Chorus Recordings

While not all customer calls are recorded, many are, and they can be a wealth of information. To avoid becoming overwhelmed, ask the previous account team if there are any impactful or informative calls to watch, and review any with a subject line that may be particularly interesting (ex. EBRs, product feedback, etc.) or that could help fill in some gaps from meeting notes.

Support Tickets

Thoroughly understand the main technical issues the customer cares about and has had problems with. Take note of critical open tickets and collaborate with support as needed, and review any key technical issues the customer experienced in the past; for example, migrations, integrations, major upgrades, etc.

As the new CSM is finally responsible for knowing about important support tickets and its status, its recommended to subscribe yourself (in "CC") to all support tickets, the old CSM was watching. This will ensure, that the new CSM gets notified (as the old CSM will remove herself from the CC list).

Installation

Assess the environment where the customer's GitLab instance is hosted.

- Self-Managed Assessment:
 - Health Checks
 - Architecture diagrams
 - Machine specifications
 - GitLab configuration files
- GitLab.com (SaaS) Assessment:
 - Runners Evaluation
 - Private On-Prem Runners
 - Compute minutes utilization
 - CI usage trends (i.e daily, weekly, monthly etc.)

SECTION: customer-success/csm/aspiring-leaders-program.md

CSM Aspiring Leaders Program Overview

The CSM Leadership team is invested in ensuring CSMs have continuous career development and can reach their career goals. This page is a framework to help ICs who are interested in becoming a manager take deliberate steps to achieve that goal.

It's important for interested CSMs to know that going through this framework and completing all steps does not guarantee a promotion. Most importantly, a vacancy must be open, and an IC must

apply and go through the interview process along with external candidates. Then, the IC must be the best person for the job, demonstrating leadership competencies and strategic vision and execution.

It is typical for a CSM to be in a Senior or Staff CSM role at GitLab prior to becoming a manager, as the responsibilities of a Senior CSM include taking on more leadership within their team. However, this is not required, and Intermediate CSMs can and have been promoted directly into a management role, although prior management experience is typically a factor.

Ongoing Activities

As you progress through this guide, it's important to keep the following items top of mind at all times:

1. Have ongoing regular calls with your manager on your growth plan and progress towards your goals.
1. Create and keep up-to-date a record of your achievements that you can reference.
1. Identify any gaps in your skills so that you can focus your efforts on leveling up, through coaching, mentorship, and training.
1. Maintain high performance at your current job, showing competency and proactiveness with your book of business and your scope of work.
1. Demonstrate consistency in your leadership, through owning projects, helping your peers, and being a thought leader.

Module 1: Explore

To kick off this guide, it's important to understand what being a manager entails at a high-level, why you specifically want to be a manager, and what you are looking for out of management.

1. Have a career growth conversation with your manager about your goals and their feedback for you, using the following example questions during your discussion:
 - Why do you want to be a manager?
 - What do you envision being a manager to be like?
 - What do you anticipate being the best part of being a manager and why? What about the worst part and why?
 - What team do you want to lead / what team is best suited for your skills and experience?

Why?

1. Have coffee chats with multiple CSM Managers about their experiences in management (and, if applicable, their experience being promoted into the role from being an IC).
1. Review GitLab's Growth & Development budget and identify opportunities to use this benefit for growing your leadership skills.

Module 2: Learn

Once you feel confident you're interested in exploring management, it's time to learn more about what management is like and grow your skills.

1. Find a mentor for yourself who is in a manager or higher role and can help you grow your leadership skills.

- How to find a mentor:
 - Seek recommendations from your own manager or fellow CSMs.
 - Connect directly with existing managers via Slack or coffee chats to express your interest in finding a mentor.
 - Attend meetings outside of your existing sales segment for exposure to other CSM managers in action, e.g. as a Commercial CSM ask to attend a PubSec All Hands or QBR.
 - Be proactive and persistent!
 - Consider participating in the GitLab mentorship program if currently open.
- What to discuss in mentorship calls:
 - During your first call, suggest a meeting cadence going forward.
 - Be prepared and succinct; consider sharing an agenda ahead of time that includes your leadership goals and what questions you have for your mentor.
 - Ask for feedback on your existing work; consider sharing a success plan or success story that you're proud of, or a story where you feel like you could have handled a situation better.
 - Explore leadership styles; ask your mentor about theirs and share your vision of your own leadership style.
 - Leave each meeting with agreed-upon action items for both parties.
- 1. Read through the leadership page of the handbook.
 - See if any recommended leadership books interest you and, if so, expense them.
- 1. Take the Elevate course provided by the L&D team if available.
- 1. Take the Crucial Conversations course.
- 1. Review to see if there is a new LifeLabs cohort coming soon.
- 1. Take the New Manager Foundations LinkedIn Learning course.
- 1. Take the Being a Good Mentor LinkedIn Learning course.
- 1. Watch free webinars and training resources through Sounding Board.
- 1. Review the CEO Shadow Program and potentially sign up for it (benefits include seeing firsthand how other leaders work and the types of discussions they have, among many others).
- 1. Develop relationships with other leaders in the organization, such as ASMs and SA Managers, through coffee chats and customer strategy.
- 1. Shadow 1:1 conversations between CS leadership to learn more about the types of conversations leaders have regularly.
 - Participants can opt to shadow the following 1:1 meetings:
 - Participant's Manager with Director/VP.
 - Participant's Director with VP (if applicable).
 - Work with the person closest to you in your reporting line for each meeting to arrange shadowing by reaching out to them in Slack or asking in a 1:1. That person will provide you with the needed details, including:
 - Invite to the meeting, with a notes document specifically for that session.
 - Any specific things to know ahead of the meeting, such as anything you may be asked to contribute.
 - Meeting owners: in preparing for your 1:1 to be shadowed by a member of the team, please ensure the following:
 - The meeting invite is provided to the team member with sufficient time for them to arrange their schedule to accommodate (typically at least a week in advance).
 - You provide a separate notes document for that specific session, and not your standard 1:1 running notes document.
 - If there is any input or contribution you would like from the team member during the meeting, inform them ahead of time so they can be prepared.
 - There may be circumstances for which the meeting owner will decline a shadow for a

specific session, but the meeting owner should offer an alternative session for shadowing when this happens.

- During the 1:1 meeting, discussion and topics are covered as they would be normally, to allow the team member to learn from their observations in a meaningful way. However, a few things should be considered:

- Some points of discussion may be sensitive and not appropriate for the team member to be present for. Meeting owners should keep these items in their standard 1:1 running notes document so they remain private, and move these to the end of the meeting agenda. Once the meeting participants have reached these items, the meeting owner will ask the shadowing team member to drop from the meeting, and then the 1:1 can proceed.

- The shadowing team member is encouraged to note any items for which they have questions, and the meeting owner is encouraged to build in time for those questions either throughout the 1:1 or at a specific point at the end of the session. The meeting owner should set expectations with the shadowing team member ahead of the meeting on when and how is best to ask questions (e.g. throughout the meeting as they come up, wait for a queue from the meeting owner at specific intervals, or at a designated point at the end of the meeting).

- Following the 1:1, the shadowing team member should plan to discuss it with their mentor and/or manager to review their observations and identify any areas of focus from what they learned.

- If a participant would like to shadow a given 1:1 pairing more than once, please feel free to ask! The purpose of this process is to provide learning opportunities for participants, so feel empowered to seek the opportunities that would help you in your learning path.

Module 3: Practice

It's important to take the learnings you've gained and put them into action, so that you can have firsthand experience yourself. The below tasks will give you the opportunity to go through what a CSM Manager may in their daily work.

1. Participate regularly in OKRs as a primary contributor, showing consistency of participation, ownership of your tasks, collaboration with other contributors, and proactiveness during the OKRs.

1. Find a mentee that you are working with, helping them to achieve their own growth goals and coaching them through challenges and questions.

- How to find a mentee:

- Make it known you are interested in becoming a mentor and consider sharing why (e.g. mentors have made a big impact on you, you are interested in developing people outside your org, etc.). Do this in team calls, all-CSM calls, or via Slack channels like tim-tams.

- Approach people directly that you feel may benefit or be interested in a mentor.

- Seek recommendations from managers and above on anyone they think could be a good match for you.

- What to discuss in mentorship calls:

- Be present, be honest, and be vulnerable. Don't share just your successes - often the best learnings come from failures. Foster a safe environment for these conversations, where the mentee feels safe sharing both their failures and successes too.

- Be prepared, and review any agenda they have provided in advance, taking time to think of examples to share or questions to ask.

- Ensure you are giving your mentee your full attention during the call.

- Utilize coaching methods to help your mentee figure things out on their own.

- Encourage your mentee to set realistic goals so they have something to strive for and

can measure their progress.

- Challenge your mentee to try new things and stretch themselves.
- Take ownership of your action items and always deliver on anything you've said you'll do for your mentee.

1. Take ownership of a project from start to finish that benefits people outside of your immediate scope (e.g. the rest of the CSMs, other departments, a large number of customers, etc.).

- A common example of this is participating in CSM Big Rocks and OKRs (which is why it's task 1 in Module 3!). However, CSMs are encouraged to identify and drive creative solutions for problems or gaps, outside of OKRs. A great way to find these opportunities is to think about what you wish could be better, or where you have a unique skillset or background that could help others. Here are some examples:

- Identifying a gap in a process or tool (e.g. customer onboarding, Gainsight playbooks, issue/handbook/Drive organization, etc.), researching options, discussing feedback with customers and peers, creating new content where needed, and working with team members to launch the content.

- Creating new/updated content and training on a topic related to the CSM role (e.g. EBRs, workshops/enablers, success plans, persona engagement, risk management, etc.) and sharing it with the wider CSM team.

- Partake in or start a working group; these are typically long-term initiatives, but very valuable to have experience with (e.g. the issue prioritization framework working group).

1. Join CSM Manager meetings and own action items that come out of that meeting.

- To attend a CSM manager meeting, ask your manager to invite you to the next planned occurrence within your region.

- When adding the participant, the CSM manager should create a separate agenda doc for the upcoming occurrence and add it to the appropriate calendar event, sharing it with all participants and transposing any existing items as appropriate from the running doc

- As a participant, you're encouraged actively participate in the discussion, assist in notetaking, and volunteer to drive next steps on any follow-up actions.

- For exposure to different regions & segments, consider reaching out to a leader within another segment and following the same process.

1. Shadow & collaborate with your manager on things that are part of their responsibilities, such as: renewal forecasting, growth planning, metrics reviews, etc.

1. When your manager has upcoming PTO, volunteer and work with them on being backup for things like escalations, 1:1s if team members are open to it, being a representative at leadership meetings, etc.

1. Prepare a mock 30-60-90 day plan as if you were preparing to become a CSM Manager, and share it with your manager & mentor for feedback. This is a requirement of the interview process for CSM Managers, and it also is extremely helpful for new managers to guide their transition and helps set them up for success.

Program Launch FY24Q2

Beginning May 2023, we will launch a pilot group for this program for any CSMs interested to join, where we hold regular calls and async discussion, discussing everyone's progress, questions, feedback, etc.

If you are interested in joining this pilot group, please keep an eye out for a sign-up form, or reach out to Chloe Whitestone, who will be leading this pilot program and can answer any questions.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/cadence-calls.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Overview

One of the primary tools CSMs have to become a trusted advisor and assess and improve account health is the customer cadence call. This is an opportunity for the CSM and the customer team to sync on business outcomes, priorities, progress on initiatives, and concerns, and it is a great opportunity to bring in other GitLab team members that the CSM feels should be included (for example, Product to review feature requests and the roadmap).

Cadence calls are an important aspect of CSM engagement to continue to understand customer's evolving needs, ensure GitLab is delivering value and outcomes, unblock barriers, address issues, collect feedback, nurture relationships, and ensure the customer continues to have positive experiences.

Frequency

- CSMs: Cadence calls should be weekly during onboarding and otherwise at least biweekly, considering specific customer needs and stage in customer lifecycle.
- Scale CSEs: Cadence calls are not scheduled on an ongoing basis for Scale CSE customers. Calls with customers are offered programmatically based on the key points defined in the Scale CSE customer lifecycle.

Cadence calls should be captured in Gainsight, which drives the Engagement scorecard metric.

Lifecycle of a cadence call

An effective cadence call involves more than just the call itself. There are several stages that occur before, during, and after the call.

Preparation for the call

Leading up to a cadence call, the CSM should prepare a meeting agenda. This is the foundation of an effective call, and should be collaborated on by all attendees. The agenda should be made available to everyone at least a few days in advance of the call.

Recommended details to include in the agenda include

- Attendees, both from GitLab and from the customer
- Advance materials or read-only items
- Discussion topics (see suggested discussion topics)
 - Leave room for the customer to bring up unplanned topics or questions
- Recap & Next Steps

The collaboration project template includes a meeting agenda issue template that is structured to follow this format. (Note: Scale CSM customers do not receive/use a collaboration project)

The topics and the naming of the cadence call (when you send an invite to the customer) are also an important part of the CSM engagement. The following names for the cadence call have been used with success and are recommended - ordered by popularity:

- "GitLab / <CUSTOMERNAME> CSM Call"
- "GitLab - Bi-weekly Collaboration" (Adapt, depending on the frequency)
- "GitLab - CSM Call"

By developing an agenda and doing advance preparation for the meeting, the CSM (and the rest of the account team) will be ready with relevant questions and information for the customer.

Tasklist for the first cadence call

The following items are to be covered/completed in your initial cadence call/kickoff call with a customer:

- Have introductions between the account team and the customer
- Identify purchase reasons and primary use cases
- Identify training needs and agree on enablement sessions
 - New Customers: Discuss the Intro to GitLab and the Intro to CI/CD enablement sessions in your first cadence call
 - Existing Customers: Discuss other enablement sessions in-line with their desired use cases and potential expansion opportunities (it can be helpful to start discussing future sessions/topics right after one is delivered and it's fresh in their mind)
 - Scale Customers: Share the landing page for upcoming webinars, and encourage them to sign up for the Intro to GitLab and the Intro to CI/CD webinars at a minimum
- Share our support offerings
- If the customer is on a self-managed subscription:
 - Strongly advise that they sign-up for security alerts, which they can do by entering their email address in the "Sign up for security notices" section of this page
 - Share the Communication Preference Center link so that customers can manage the emails they get from GitLab
- If the customer is on a SaaS subscription:
 - Share Status and Communications Preferences pages with customer and advise that they opt-in to security alerts
 - Subscribe the GitLab Admin to Status page updates
- Set up recurring cadence calls (CSM-managed only)

Prep for ongoing cadence calls

After the initial call, you will have subsequent cadence calls, each of which you will need to prep for and ensure is an impactful and successful meeting.

Prior to the call, review the following items:

- Success plan objectives and progress
- Open CTAs

- Last timeline entry/notes doc to ensure follow-up items were closed out and if not, follow up on them during the next call
- Renewal date to be aware of upcoming renewal
- License utilization - if it is lower and the customer is in the second half of their annual contract, discuss the trends around this and expected behavior; if it is above or close to their purchased amount, ensure they are aware and loop in your SAE/AE
- Use case scoring, identifying areas where the customer is not green - discuss one or two on the call and include the value of adoption these areas and suggest enablement opportunities
- Has the customer signed up for security alerts? It's critical to ensure that customers (especially those that are self-managed) sign up for GitLab security alerts, which they can do by entering their email address in the "Sign up for security notices" section of this page. CSMS can monitor whether or not their customers are signed up for security alerts by looking at the relevant SFDC reports for contacts (most customers will fall into this category) and leads. It is recommended to save versions of those SFDC reports with your preferred filters in your Personal Custom Reports folder in SFDC for efficiency and to avoid accidentally modifying the original reports. You can do this by opening the report, selecting "Save As", renaming the report, and saving it to "My Personal Custom Reports". From there, you can modify the report to include your desired filters. If a customer does not sign up for security alerts in between the kickoff call and the first cadence call, CSMS should revisit this topic in subsequent conversations and emphasize that opting in to these notifications will ensure the customer is aware of any action they may need to take to keep their instance(s) secure.

With every customer call, always be sure to have an agenda prepared and share it with the customer in advance. Here is a template that some CSMS use to prepare agendas for customer meetings.

Additionally, there may be specific items that are worthwhile to discuss about their self-managed subscription on a regular basis:

- Discuss monthly releases & inquire about frequency of their planned upgrades, letting them know about our maintenance policy
- Inform customer about our reference architectures and that these are the only supported architectures
 - Inquire about current and projected user count to ensure the architecture allows for future growth and is the appropriate scale
- Inform customer about the GitLab Performance Tool
- Inform customer about our support offering